

Deal 1 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners

Q753♣

62♦

A76♠

QJ94♥

A964♣ A83♦ KQJ5♠ K10♥

Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners			
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners

AK5♣

K5♦

A76♠

A8653♥

9843♣ QJ1073♦ 82♠ K4♥

Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners			
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ A 8 7 3
♦ 9 7 4
♣ J 10 2

♠ K Q J 5

♥ K 10

♦ A 8 3

♣ A 9 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8 4

♥ 6 5 2

♦ K Q J 10 5

♣ K 8

♠ A 7 6

♥ Q J 9 4

♦ 6 2

♣ Q 7 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

You were lucky the ♥A was with West.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♦K.

Winners: ♠=4 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 6

You need 3 more winners, and they must come from the ♥ suit. The danger is that when you knock out the ♥A, East may take too many ♦s. To exhaust West of ♦s you hold-up your ♦A until the third round.

Next you start on ♥s by playing ♥K, then overtaking the ♥10. Assume that West wins the second ♥.

You were fortunate it was West who took the ♥A, and that he has no ♦ to return. If he plays a ♥ or a ♠ you will win in dummy. If he plays a ♣ you will jump up with the ♣A and take your winners, 9 in all.

But if you had not held-up your ♦A even good luck wouldn't have helped you.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 7 6
 ♥ A 8 6 5 3
 ♦ K 5
 ♣ A K 5

♠ 9 4 3
 ♥ Q 9 7 2
 ♦ A 8 4
 ♣ Q 10 2



♠ 8 2
 ♥ K 4
 ♦ Q J 10 7 3
 ♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ K Q J 10 5
 ♥ J 10
 ♦ 9 6 2
 ♣ J 7 6

West	North	East	South
1♥	Pass	1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East bank; ♠A, ♦K, ♦Q. You take your ♥K, cash the two good ♦s, then lead to dummy for the ♣A K and ♥A. Voila!

You were lucky that North had the ♦A since he only had 3 ♠s.

But what if North actually held 4 ♠s? No problem, in that case the ♠s would have split 4-4 so the defenders could only win 3 ♠ tricks and the ♦A.

The hold-up lets you make the contract whenever North holds the ♦A. And if South happened to hold the ♦A??? You go down.

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠K.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 5

Even if ♥s split 3-3 you could only get 2 extra winners there, so it should be clear that you must establish the ♦s. You will have to drive out the ♦A and hope they don't win too many ♠s at that time. You can help your chances by a hold-up of the ♠A until the third round.

Having just taken the third ♠ trick you now work on ♦s by first playing the ♦K, then continuing the suit. North wins the third one with his ♦A. And now the good news - he has no ♠ left to reach his partner's good tricks. So North plays the ♥Q.

At this point in the play you have three tricks in the

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 7 3 2

♥ 10 7

♦ 6 5

♣ J 10 8 2

♠ 10 5

♥ K 8 5 4

♦ A 10 9 3

♣ K 6 5



♠ A 8 6

♥ Q J 9 2

♦ K 7 4

♣ 9 7 3

♠ K 9 4

♥ A 6 3

♦ Q J 8 2

♣ A Q 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

Pass

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♦

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

the other suits. You don't care which he leads because you can now win 8 more tricks and make your contract.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠3. East wins the first trick with the ♠A and returns the ♠8.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 7

You can win 3 more ♦ tricks if the finesse works, but even if it doesn't work you can still get the 2 that you need. Of course if East does win the ♦K it would sure be great if he had no ♠ to lead. So you duck the second ♠ and take your ♠K when they play a third round.

After winning the ♠K you are conveniently in your hand, so you play the ♦Q and let it ride when West plays a low card. Alas, East takes the trick with his ♦K.

It's too bad the finesse didn't work, but it's not too too bad! Because East is out of ♠s and must lead one of

As long as you were going to finesse into East you could establish the ♦s without allowing West to gain the lead.

And as long as you had held up on the ♠K until the third round you could ensure that East was out of ♠s if he had started with only 3.